

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Level of analysis

VARNA -> four-fold textual ideal type, normative

JATI -> local endogamous birth group, observable

SUB-JATI -> narrower endogamy circle inside a jati

RULE -> answer at the jati level, argue with the varna template

MUST REMEMBER: Caste joins varna ideology, locally ranked jatis, endogamy, hereditary occupation, purity-pollution, social closure and power; Sanskritisation, dominant caste, secularisation, politicisation and caste-class mobility explain change without implying disappearance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Four features and their rate of change

ENDOGAMY -> most consistently observed, changes least
HIERARCHY -> locally ranked by purity and pollution
HEREDITARY MEMBERSHIP -> fixed by birth
OCCUPATION LINK -> weakest joint, broken by urban work

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Marriage rules that operate together

CASTE ENDOGAMY -> marry within the jati

GOTRA EXOGAMY -> marry outside the clan lineage

RESULT -> a bounded but non-consanguineous marriage circle

CONSEQUENCE -> caste is reproduced generation by generation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Mobility strategies

SANSKRITISATION -> emulate a locally higher-status caste

EFFECT -> claims rank inside the existing hierarchy

WESTERNISATION -> new values from Western contact

EFFECT -> can subvert the hierarchy rather than confirm it

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Dominant caste test

NUMBERS -> is the caste locally numerous

LAND -> does it hold a significant share of local land

OFFICE -> does it control political and Panchayat positions

VERDICT -> dominance can sit below the ritual top

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Caste and class

OVERLAP -> caste rank and economic class coincide locally

CROSS-CUTTING -> rich and poor households inside one caste

DRIVER -> urban employment and market credentials

LIMIT -> the overlap is loosening, not abolished

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Varna is not jati, caste is not class, ritual rank is not identical to economic or political power, untouchability is not every caste inequality, and constitutional Scheduled Caste status is a legal-administrative category rather than a complete sociological map.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Associational reinvention

WEAKENED -> occupational allocation and public purity enforcement

REPLACED BY -> caste associations, trusts and electoral blocs

UNCHANGED -> endogamy and intimate-sphere discrimination

VERDICT -> change of register, not disappearance

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Fluid and static resolved by level

STATIC LAYER -> endogamy, hereditary membership, segregation

FLUID LAYER -> rank claims, dominance, market mobility

WHY -> rank is locally constructed, boundary is marital

ANSWER -> the paradox is a level distinction, not a contradiction

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Identity axes by arena

MARRIAGE -> jati and sub-jati decide the boundary

SHRINE AND DEVOTION -> sect through doctrine and lineage

ELECTORAL MOBILISATION -> jati clusters and religion

DEVELOPMENT GRIEVANCE -> region and language

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Two marriage boundaries

INTERCASTE -> parity protects status and resource base

INTERRELIGIOUS -> belonging, kinship and community sanction

CIVIL ROUTE -> Special Marriage Act, 1954 exists across religions

VERDICT -> different guards, therefore different speeds

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Measurement status

PIB 30 APRIL 2025 -> caste enumeration announced for Census 2027

GAZETTE S.O. 2681(E) -> fixes the reference dates

STATUS -> prospective, so no caste count may be quoted

LIMIT -> not India's first historical caste enumeration

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Caste answer spine

OPEN -> name the level and the demand family

BODY -> structure, mobility, dominance, association

TENSION -> what changed against what did not

CLOSE -> arena-specific verdict with the measurement caveat

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Articles 15-17, 46, 330-342A and reservation institutions set legal boundaries, but legal prohibition does not equal social eradication; compare Jat, Maratha, Patidar, Dalit and regional caste dynamics without homogenising communities or inferring causes from aggregate correlations.